ASPPH Launches AI-Powered Platform to Help Transform Public Health Education

New Public Health AI Curriculum Transformation Platform will help faculty responsibly integrate AI into teaching and prepare students for an AI-enabled workforce

WASHINGTON, D.C. [September 2026]—The Association of Schools and Programs of Public Health (ASPPH) today announced the launch of the Public Health AI Curriculum Transformation Platform (PHACT), an AI-enabled initiative that builds on ASPPH's existing investments in AI, workforce development, educational resources, and digital innovation to help schools and programs of public health prepare students and faculty for a rapidly changing workforce.

Artificial intelligence is transforming how public health professionals analyze data, conduct research, communicate with communities, respond to emergencies, and address complex health challenges. Yet the pace of technological change is creating a significant challenge for higher education: faculty are increasingly being asked to incorporate AI into their teaching while often lacking the training, tools, resources, and institutional support needed to do so effectively and responsibly.

PHACT will help bridge that gap by providing shared infrastructure that enables public health faculty to modernize curricula, access trusted educational resources, experiment with AI tools, and learn alongside colleagues across institutions. By creating shared capabilities that would be costly and duplicative for individual institutions to develop independently, PHACT will provide tangible value to ASPPH members while accelerating responsible AI adoption across the field.

"As artificial intelligence rapidly reshapes research, teaching, and workforce systems, ASPPH is guiding the academic public health community toward responsible and ethical AI adoption," said Laura Magaña, PhD, MS, President and CEO of ASPPH. "PHACT builds on this commitment by creating a thoughtful, value-driven approach to integrating AI into public health education and practice. Through shared technology, evidence, faculty expertise, and trusted resources, we can help ensure that innovation strengthens educational quality and remains grounded in the needs of public health."

The platform will build on ASPPH's existing technology and educational infrastructure, including **MyASPPH**, its member engagement platform, and **ARIE** (AI Resource for Institutional Excellence),

developed in collaboration with Amazon Web Services (AWS). PHACT represents the next stage of an established roadmap, integrating these existing capabilities with workforce intelligence, competency resources, faculty collaboration, and new AWS-powered AI services.

Faculty will be able to use an AI Curriculum Transformation Assistant to analyze syllabi, learning objectives, assignments, and other instructional materials and identify opportunities to responsibly incorporate AI into courses. A new AI Competency Intelligence Engine will connect emerging workforce needs with educational competencies and teaching practices. Building on ASPPH's existing workforce and job-task analyses, the Engine will help identify evolving employer needs and use AI-facilitated competency coverage analysis and visual heatmaps to help institutions identify curricular strengths, gaps, and opportunities for innovation. Faculty will also have access to shared AI-enabled learning resources, peer learning communities, and secure environments where they can explore AI applications and public health datasets before bringing them into the classroom.

Importantly, PHACT is designed around a human-in-the-loop approach. AI-generated recommendations will support, not replace, faculty expertise and professional judgment. The platform will incorporate trusted ASPPH resources, competency frameworks, workforce analyses, accreditation-related guidance, and faculty-developed materials to ground its recommendations in authoritative academic public health knowledge.

ASPPH will initially pilot PHACT with approximately 10–20 faculty champions across 5–10 member institutions, with a goal of supporting the adaptation of 10–15 courses, developing at least 10 AI-enabled learning modules and teaching resources, and reaching more than 250 students through AI-enhanced curricula. Feedback from participating faculty will guide continued refinement and broader adoption. The pilot is designed to validate a model that can scale across ASPPH's network of more than 150+ CEPH-accredited schools and programs of public health and a community of more than 103,000 deans, faculty, staff and students.

"PHACT gives faculty a practical way to bring AI into the classroom without having to start from scratch," said Melissa Perry, Sc.D., MHS, MBA, Dean, George Mason University College of Public Health. "By helping instructors adapt courses, access trusted resources, and safely test new approaches, the platform can make it easier to create learning experiences that are engaging, relevant, and connected to the skills students will need in an AI-enabled workforce. With the potential to reach more than 250 students through the initial pilot alone, PHACT represents an important opportunity to help academic public health move forward together and prepare graduates to use AI responsibly and effectively."

Beyond the initial pilot, ASPPH plans to integrate validated PHACT capabilities into its long-term member services and educational infrastructure, creating a scalable resource for the academic public health community and a potential model for other areas of higher education facing similar challenges.

AWS support will accelerate an implementation roadmap already underway, providing the technical capacity to integrate existing ASPPH assets, develop and validate new capabilities, and move the platform to broader adoption.

About ASPPH

The Association of Schools and Programs of Public Health (ASPPH) represents more than 150 accredited schools and programs of public health, including a community of more than 103,000 deans, faculty, staff, and students. ASPPH is the voice of academic public health – we train the next generation of public health professionals, convene leaders, generate evidence, and advocate for policies that improve the health and well-being of everyone, everywhere. ASPPH envisions a world where all people live in thriving communities supported by the work of resilient and competent public health professionals.

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